ACCESSIBLE DESIGN

TIPS FOR UI DESIGNERS

Be Accessible®

What is accessible web design?

Accessible web design provides a website that all users can navigate, understand, and interact with regardless of their abilities.

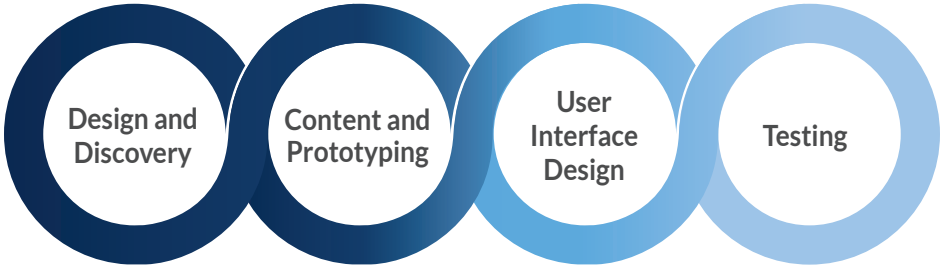
According to the **W**eb **C**ontent **A**ccessibility **G**uidelines (WCAG) provided by the **W**orld **W**ide **W**eb **C**onsortium (W3C), an accessible website is perceivable, operable, understandable, and robust.

Who is responsible for creating accessible websites?

Each designer has an important role during development to ensure accessible results. Working together, designers ensure web content is accessible to people with a variety of abilities.

The tables on the following pages define what each designer is responsible for providing, when they should be included in the development process, and how their expertise impacts accessibility.

Example of a four-stage development process:



How do I use WCAG?

Web accessibility testing involves an extensive step-by-step process of manual evaluation and is best achieved during the development phase of a website.

WCAG's four principles include testable success criteria that are divided into three levels of conformance: Level A, Level AA, and Level AAA. Each level is defined based on a set of success criteria.

You can find WCAG online at https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG21/

Is WCAG Enough?

Although WCAG is extensive, real users testing is required to confirm a website's accessibility. Include disabled users in your web accessibility testing process.

If your development team needs accessibility training, contact Be Accessible. We will provide the guidance needed to ensure your website is accessible to everyone.

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User Interface Designers

UI designers have the greatest impact on accessible web development. Hypertext markup language (HTML), cascading style sheets (CSS), and JavaScript (JS) are key components to an accessible design and the responsibility of a UI designer to implement.

DO	DON'T	WHY
Use skip to content links	**TAB TAB TAB** Force user to tab through repeated content	Keyboard-only users rely on skip links to bypass repeated links.
<H1> **<H2>** **<H3>** Use HTML heading elements	**<p style="font-weight: bold">** Use CSS to style heading text without HTML heading markup	Screen readers depend on semantic HTML to inform users of content relationships.
Use sufficient color contrast	Use low color contrast	People with various color dependencies require a certain level of color contrast to distinguish content from its background.
Use relative styles	Use absolute styles	Relative styles prevent content from overlapping with text-only zoom
Create responsive designs	Exclude error messages	Responsive design prevents horizontal scrolling and reduces confusion for people with cognitive disabilities. It also includes adequate target sizes for people with limited dexterity.

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DO	DON'T	WHY
Allow keyboard access	Rely on mouse dependency	Keyboard-only users cannot access mouse-dependent input
HEADING TEXT TEXT Position content in the correct order in HTML	TEXT HEADING TEXT Use absolute positioning to rearrange content	Screen readers follow HTML order. Users will hear content out of order if the visual appearance is altered by CSS positioning.
{CSS} Use CSS classes to style elements	#ID #ID #ID #ID #ID #ID #ID #ID #ID Repeatedly use ID attributes to style elements	Screen readers rely on unique ID attributes to convey information.
<label for="male">Male</label> Include labels on all form elements	label {display: none} Hide form labels	Screen readers use HTML label elements to identify form fields.
Be Accessible® Use accessible developers	Use plugins that block accessibility	Designers will create accessible designs only to add barriers when implementing third-party code.